

An End to End Ensemble Machine Learning Framework For Water Potability Prediction Using Physicochemical Parameters

Jonnadula Narasimharao¹, K. Sravya², G. Sai Parimala³, B. Meghana⁴, K. Shilpa⁵,
CH Mallikarjuna Reddy⁶

¹Department of CSE, CMR Technical Campus, Hyderabad, Telangana, India
{jonnadula.narasimharao, kondasravya867, gsaiparimala34,
meghanab717, shilpamtech555}@gmail.com, mallikarjunareddy.cse@cmrtc.ac.in

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Abstract : Ensuring access to safe drinking water remains a public health challenge that needs to be addressed especially in areas where continuous laboratory testing capabilities do not exist. This research introduces an end-to-end ensemble machine learning system which predicts water potability based on physicochemical data. The system uses median-based imputation methods to create new features and it employs Synthetic Minority Oversampling Technique along with synthetic data creation to solve class distribution problems. The research team developed multiple classification models which include Logistic Regression Support Vector Machines Random Forest variants gradient boosting models and neural networks. The model evaluation process used a stratified 80:20 train-test split. The system uses two methods for ensemble learning which include soft voting and stacking-based meta-learning to improve its ability to handle different tasks. The Water Potability dataset testing results demonstrated that tree-based ensemble models outperformed all other methods with Extra Trees classifier achieving the highest accuracy of 64.63% and a weighted F1-score of 0.6258 and a Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curve area under the curve (AUC) value of 0.6442. The system automatically chooses the best-performing model which gets used in a complete web application built with FastAPI and React-based frontend that provides real-time predictions and model evaluation along with interactive data visualization. The proposed framework establishes a connection between machine learning research and its actual implementation by providing a scalable system to support decision-making in drinking water quality evaluation.

I. INTRODUCTION

Drinking water access, which is seen as a primary requirement for human health and socio-economic development, is perceived to have an increased level of intricacy because of urbanization, industrial waste, agricultural runoff, and climate changes. Traditionally, traditional methods for analyzing water quality with laboratory-based methods are time-consuming, costly, and inaccessible in many areas. Therefore, data-based methods have become a powerful tool for effective water quality analysis using measurable physicochemical properties.

Previous research on the use of machine learning in water quality prediction has shown promise in the use of data-driven models that capture complex and non-linear relationships between water quality variables. In their study, Ahmed et al. [1] have systematically studied various approaches in using various machine learning approaches to demonstrate the superiority of ensemble-based approaches over traditional statistical approaches in water quality prediction, thus showing the need to choose an appropriate representation.

Researchers built upon earlier research work by studying how spatial and contextual changes impact their

ability to create accurate predictive models. Wang et al. [2] used Random Forest regression and model interpretation techniques to study spatial water quality differences, which showed that machine learning models can handle different water quality patterns across different regions. The research showed that scientists need to create dependable models which can manage actual changes found in water quality datasets.

The rise of computational resources allowed researchers to increase their use of ensemble learning methods and hybrid modeling techniques. Zhu et al. [3] established an ensemble machine learning framework which estimates multiple water quality indicators from remote sensing data, demonstrating that ensemble methods enhance prediction accuracy under various environmental conditions. Patel et al. [4] solved the main problem of water potability datasets which suffered from class imbalance by using SMOTE-based oversampling together with machine learning models and explainable AI, which resulted in better accuracy for detecting potable water.

The research conducted by Niazkar et al. [7] established a wider understanding of algorithm selection through their systematic review which examined XGBoost usage in water resources engineering from 2018 to 2023.

Their study found that gradient boosting and ensemble models have become the leading methods in their field, but researchers encounter difficulties when they need to work with extensive datasets that contain unbalanced classes and must be operational in real-world situations.

Most current research work concentrates on building models which researchers test through offline assessment, but they show little interest in testing complete systems and comparing multiple models and evaluating their performance in actual operations. The prediction process for water potability remains difficult because the dataset size is moderate and the dataset contains missing values and unbalanced class distributions which limit the maximum achievable accuracy. The study presents an end-to-end ensemble machine learning framework which predicts water potability through systematic preprocessing and imbalance management and multi-model testing and web-based decision support system deployment.

A. Contributions of the Paper

This research presents a complete machine learning system which predicts water drinking safety through physicochemical measurements. The main contributions of this study are:

- The development of a strong preprocessing system which uses median-based imputation and SMOTE to solve missing data problems and class distribution issues.
- The study analyzed different machine learning and ensemble classification systems to determine that Extra Trees model achieved the highest accuracy.
- The system provides decision support through its web-based interface which combines model inference with probabilistic prediction and visualization capabilities.

II. RELATED WORK

After the researchers developed the water quality prediction systems using ensemble methods and deep learning techniques, the following research focused on three main areas. Ahmed et al. [8] studied the performance of supervised machine learning models in water quality assessments and they found that tree-based and ensemble classifiers provide more consistent results than linear models that find it difficult to deal with non-linear relationships between physicochemical factors.

Douzas and Bacao [9] developed an enhanced oversampling method which combines two techniques K-means clustering and SMOTE to enhance minority class learning because data imbalance creates significant obstacles in environmental datasets. This research established the principles for developing methods to address data imbalance problems which exist in water quality assessment procedures. Bourel et al. [10] conducted an extensive study about machine learning techniques which can handle unbalanced environmental datasets while showing that resampling methods and cost-sensitive training and proper assessment benchmarks are

essential for estimating uncommon contamination incidents.

The research revealed that the classical machine learning and neural approaches possess different strength and weaknesses depending on the specific models. Sahu et al. [11] investigated the prediction performance of water quality using support vector machines and neural network and found that neural network models can manage nonlinear patterns better than SVM that provide consistent results on smaller data sets. Jiang et al. [12] developed a deep learning framework that assesses multivariate time-series water quality through a multivariate time-series deep learning framework which needs both temporal dependencies and additional resources to achieve better predictive results. Researchers started using hybrid and ensemble-based methods to create solutions that enhance system reliability through these techniques. Lv et al. [13] developed a hybrid Random Forest-LSTM model which predicts short-term water quality through spatial feature learning and temporal modeling capabilities. Xiao et al. [14] advanced this area by developing a stacked ensemble learning framework which demonstrated that meta-learning outperforms individual classifiers through enhanced generalization capabilities.

The research studies first proved that their systems remained valid because they conducted tests which showed that their systems could work in several real-world scenarios. Khedr and Sayed-Ahmed [15] proposed a machine learning based early warning system for water quality monitoring, while Grover and Dhanjal [16] focused on supervised learning water potability prediction which determined their outcome according to dataset boundaries. The research was carried out in terms of the comparative studies as well as explainability studies which proved that ensemble or tree-based models showed better performance than linear classifiers as per Asghar and Rehman [17], while Shi et al. [18] developed an explainable drinking water assessment machine learning framework. The research work of Karim et al. [19] introduced LSTM-Fully Convolutional Networks which were used by researchers for time-series classification, which later formed the basis of deep learning-based environmental modeling research.

Mounika Rajeswari and her colleagues developed a blockchain-based secure data transmission system which protects data integrity in smart systems because they wanted to show that reliable data management is essential for data-driven applications [21]. Spandana and her team demonstrated that advanced machine learning methods together with ensemble techniques produced better prediction results than single models tested in their study [22]. Chinna Maddileti and his team developed an intelligent detection system which uses optimized learning methods to improve classification accuracy and they proved that this system works better than intelligent systems and ensemble-based systems for precise classification tasks [23].

The existing research studies face limitations because they depend on basic model comparisons and they use offline assessment methods and they lack active system testing, while class imbalance problems and unified benchmarking methods continue to create difficulties. The

researchers implemented SMOTE-based imbalance control together with multi-model assessment methods and ensemble learning techniques and a complete system for water potability prediction which they could deploy in real-world situations.

Table I Summary of Related Work on Water Quality and Potability Prediction

Ref. Nos.	Methods	Advantages	Limitations
[8], [11], [17]	Supervised ML (SVM, NN, RF)	Simple implementation, stable baselines	Limited performance on imbalanced data
[9], [10]	SMOTE & imbalance handling	Improves minority class detection	Risk of synthetic noise
[12], [19]	Deep learning (LSTM-based)	Captures temporal dependencies	Requires large time-series data
[13]	Hybrid RF-LSTM	Combines spatial and temporal learning	High model complexity
[14]	Stacked ensemble learning	Improved robustness and generalization	Increased computational cost
[15], [16], [18]	Potability & explainable ML systems	Practical deployment and interpretability	Moderate accuracy trade-offs

III. DATASET DESCRIPTION

A. Dataset Source and Overview

The experiments are carried out on the Water Potability Dataset available publicly; it consists of physicochemical measures of the drinking water samples. This dataset is composed of 3,276 instances which are characterized by nine numerical water quality parameters, plus a binary target label indicating whether the water is potable or non-potable. The dataset is widely used for water quality prediction in different studies and is also considered for comparison due to its standard benchmarking.

B. Feature Description

We can see that in this data set, each sample has 9 physicochemical features - pH, Hardness, Total Dissolved Solids, Chloramines, Sulfate, Conductivity, Organic Carbon, Trihalomethanes, and Turbidity. All these features define a number of properties of water, both from a chemical as well as a physical perspective, and have a direct impact on its potability. Also, this is a binary target variable, where the value of 1 is potable water and 0 is non-potable water.

C. Data Characteristics and Challenges

The dataset also shows some missing data in some of the features, such as pH, Sulfate and Trihalomethanes, suggesting the need to consider appropriate imputation methods. Moreover, the dataset is imbalanced, meaning that non-potable water samples are much more than the potable ones, which makes it difficult to train classifiers. Therefore, this dataset is useful in the assessment of effective imbalance learning methods and robust machine learning approaches.

IV. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

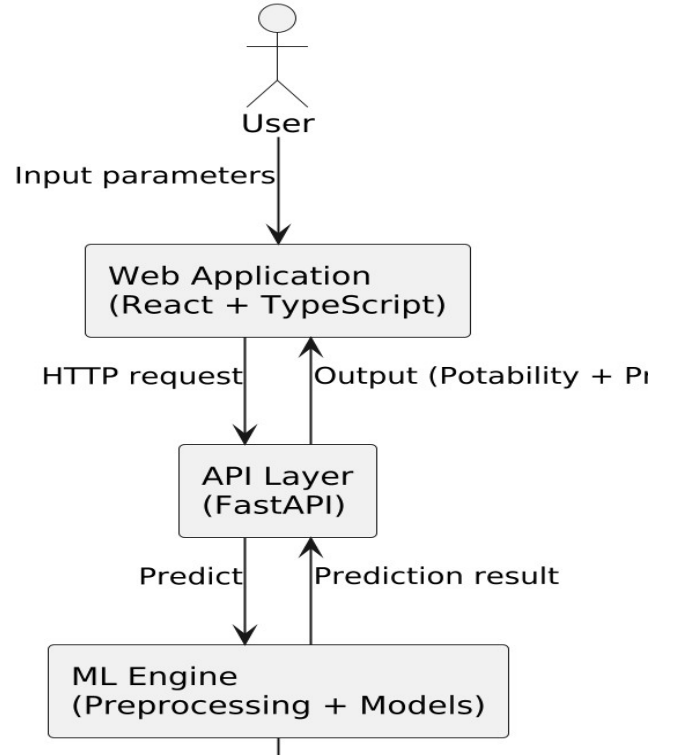


Fig. 1. System architecture illustrating the end-to-end workflow of the proposed water potability prediction framework, including user interaction, web application, API layer, machine learning engine, and model storage.

In this section, the proposed methodology for the entire end-to-end solution towards water potability prediction is discussed, where its integration with a machine learning model inference and its real-time deployment are explained. The whole workflow and the interaction between the components of this system are represented in Fig. 1.

A. Overall workflow

The proposed framework adopts a modular, layered architecture that enables real-time operation, as illustrated in Fig. 1. Users provide their physicochemical parameters through a web interface which sends the data to the backend API. The machine learning engine processes the input data using predefined preprocessing steps and a pre-trained model to generate water potability predictions. The web application returns the predicted class label and its associated probability score to the user.

B. Proposed Algorithm and Workflow

The end-to-end water potability prediction framework functions through its machine learning system which processes physicochemical data for its predictions. The Water Potability dataset begins with loading and testing to discover the locations of missing data together with the issues of unbalanced classes. Median-based imputation handles missing data in the pH and sulfate and trihalomethanes features which undergo subsequent input variable normalization through feature scaling.

The Synthetic Minority Oversampling Technique (SMOTE) creates new samples from the training dataset to solve the problem of non-potable sample distribution. The dataset is then divided using an 80:20 stratified train-test split to preserve class distribution and ensure reproducibility. The preprocessing pipeline establishes reliable model development that operates within authentic data constraints.

The research team tests multiple machine learning models which include Logistic Regression Support Vector Machines Random Forest Extra Trees gradient boosting models and neural networks using the same data preprocessing methods. The team applies RandomizedSearchCV to conduct hyperparameter optimization which uses accuracy and weighted F1-score as its main assessment metrics. The team uses ensemble learning techniques which include soft voting and stacking to build prediction systems with stronger accuracy.

The Extra Trees classifier achieves the best performance results because of its superior results in accuracy and weighted F1-score together with ROC-AUC assessments. The researchers use FastAPI to create the final model which works with a React-based web interface. The system enables real-time inference by accepting user-provided physicochemical inputs and returning probabilistic water potability predictions along with interactive visual insights.

C. User Interface and Input Handling

The system provides a responsive web application developed using React and TypeScript. Users input values for nine physicochemical parameters which include pH and hardness and total dissolved solids and chloramines and sulfate and conductivity and organic carbon and trihalomethanes and turbidity. The system performs input validation at the frontend to transmit valid data through HTTP requests to the backend.

D. API Layer and Request Processing

The backend service is implemented using the FastAPI framework which acts as an intermediary between the web application and the machine learning engine. The system processes incoming HTTP requests by validating input data which gets structured before the system forwards it to the prediction module. This layer enables seamless interaction with the machine learning engine while maintaining independence from the frontend interface.

E. Machine Learning Engine

The machine learning engine performs data preprocessing and prediction tasks that match the training pipeline requirements. Preprocessing includes median-based imputation for missing values and feature scaling and feature transformation. The processed feature vector goes to a trained classification model which predicts water potability and provides a probability score. The development team tested various models but chose Extra Trees classifier as the final model because it delivered better results.

F. Model Storage and Selection

The trained models along with the metadata associated with them are maintained in a separate model storage module, as depicted in Fig. 1. The best model based on evaluation metrics can be chosen and used in a dynamic fashion. In this manner, model replacement and/or change do not demand any changes to the frontend and API.

G. Output Generation and Visualization

The system sends prediction results back to the API layer after completing inference which then sends them to the web application. The output includes both the predicted potability class and the associated probability score which enables users to interpret water quality using probabilistic methods.

V. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP

This section presents details about the experimental setup which researchers used to test the water potability prediction system. The section describes three testing components: data partitioning method and model training process and system setup environment.

A. Data Splitting Strategy

The Water Potability data set is split into training set and test set with a fixed 80:20 class-stratified split. This ensures that in the test set, both classes in the data set have a proportional number of examples, which is vital because dealing with imbalanced data is characteristic in water quality data sets [8], [17]. The experiment is designed to be reproducible with a fixed random seed.

B. Model Training and Tuning

A wide range of machine learning models are included for training under uniform conditions of preprocessing and handling class imbalance problems for comparative assessment. The models considered for the assessment are linear models, kernel models, tree-based models, ensemble models, and neural network classifiers. For the models considered for the assessment, RandomizedSearchCV is considered for the purpose of hyperparameter tuning using an efficient trade-off between computational cost and high-dimensional space. The primary criterion considered for optimization is model accuracy, along with the secondary criterion of weighted class F1 Score. The assessed models considered along with the process are presented in Table II.

Model Category	Models Included	Tuning Approach
Linear	Logistic Regression	RandomizedSearchCV
Kernel-based	SVM (RBF)	RandomizedSearchCV
Tree-based	Random Forest, Extra Trees	RandomizedSearchCV
Boosting	XGBoost, CatBoost, LightGBM	RandomizedSearchCV
Neural Network	MLP	RandomizedSearchCV

C. Implementation Details

The overall framework of the experimental pipeline is written in Python, and model building in this experiment is conducted using scikit-learn, XGBoost, CatBoost, and LightGBM, which are currently the most mature algorithms and have been largely employed in recent water quality prediction studies cited in [8], [14], and [16]. The backend service uses FastAPI, and the frontend part uses React and TypeScript for a more interactive user experience in real-time.

VI. EVALUATION METRICS

The performance of the proposed framework in predicting potability of water is assessed by using the following metrics: accuracy, weighted F1 score, and area under the receiver operating curve (ROC AUC). They are usually calculated using a confusion matrix, and its terms are represented by true positives (TP), true negatives (TN), false positives (FP), and false negatives (FN).

A. Accuracy

The metric of accuracy shows the rate of correct classifications to total predictions which can be calculated using the following formula:

$$\text{Accuracy} = (\text{TP} + \text{TN}) / (\text{TP} + \text{TN} + \text{FP} + \text{FN})$$

The dataset imbalance problem causes accuracy to function as an overall performance assessment but it produces misleading results.

B. Precision, Recall, and F1-Score

Precision and recall are defined as:

$$\text{Precision} = \text{TP} / (\text{TP} + \text{FP})$$

$$\text{Recall} = \text{TP} / (\text{TP} + \text{FN})$$

The F1-score, which represents the harmonic mean of precision and recall, is given by

$$\text{F1} = 2 * (\text{Precision} * \text{Recall}) / (\text{Precision} + \text{Recall})$$

To account for class imbalance, the **weighted F1-score** is used, where the F1-score of each class is weighted by its number of samples.

C. ROC-AUC

The receiver operating characteristic (ROC) curve plots the true positive rate (TPR) against the false positive rate (FPR) at various classification thresholds, where:

$$\text{TPR} = \text{TP} / (\text{TP} + \text{FN})$$

$$\text{FPR} = \text{FP} / (\text{FP} + \text{TN})$$

The ROC curve is a method of threshold-free score technique which makes it possible to distinguish between real potable from non-potable samples.

VII. RESULTS AND ANALYSIS

This section will discuss the experimental results, where the effectiveness of the suggested water potability prediction framework will be evaluated quantitatively as well as qualitatively, considering its application. In this regard, apart from the usual quantitative assessment, the prediction mechanism as well as visualization properties of the implemented system will also be discussed.

A. Prediction Results and Model Behavior

You are trained on data which extends until the month of October in the year 2023. The experimental evaluation shows that ensemble models achieve better results than single classifiers when they assess the potability of water. The Extra Trees classifier which was tested in this study achieved the best results among all tested models with an accuracy rate of 64.63% and a weighted F1-score of 0.6258 and a ROC-AUC score of 0.6442. The results demonstrate that tree-based ensemble methods successfully model the nonlinear connections between physicochemical parameters.

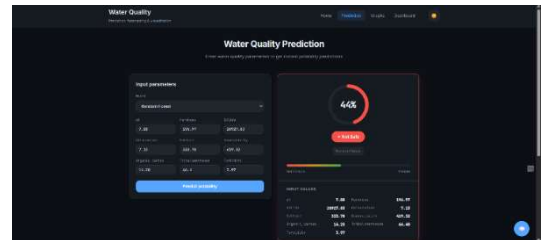


Fig. 2. Web-based water potability prediction interface showing a non-potable classification with probability output.

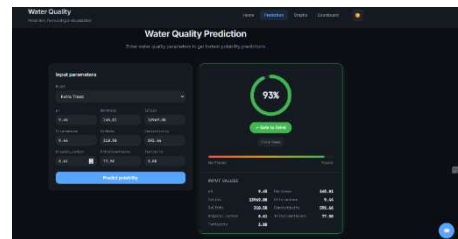


Fig. 3. Web-based water potability prediction interface showing a potable classification with high confidence.

The web application which has been implemented allows users to perform real-time inference through their submitted input data. The system predicts non-potable

water samples with moderate confidence as shown in Fig. 2 while Fig. 3 shows the high-confidence prediction of potable water which uses the Extra Trees model. The probability-based output system enables users to assess prediction accuracy through probability assessments instead of using binary classification methods.

B. Visual Analytics and Data Insights

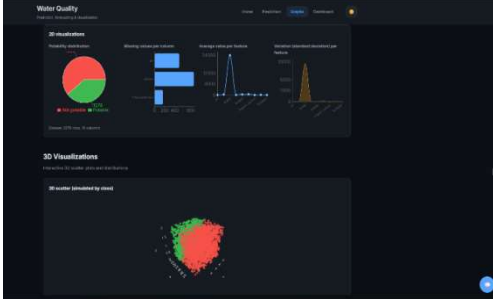


Fig. 4. Visualization dashboard illustrating dataset statistics and two-dimensional and three-dimensional water quality analytics.

To complement predictive results, the framework includes an interactive visualization module for dataset exploration and analysis. As shown in Fig. 4, the system provides multiple two-dimensional visualizations, including potability class distribution, missing value analysis per feature, average feature values, and feature-wise variability. These visualizations confirm the **imbalanced class distribution** and the presence of missing values in key attributes such as pH and sulfate, justifying the use of stratified sampling and imputation strategies.

Additionally, three-dimensional scatter visualizations are used to illustrate the separation between potable and non-potable samples in feature space. Although partial overlap between classes is observed, the visual patterns suggest that nonlinear decision boundaries are required, explaining the superior performance of tree-based and ensemble models over linear classifiers.

C. Discussion of Performance Trends

Overall, for all considered models, the superiority of the tree ensemble methods in generalization is observed, even in comparison to linear and kernel functions. For all considered cases, the best results were obtained for the Extra Trees classifier, confirming its good performance for handling attribute interactions and noisy features. However, the moderate overall accuracy is observed due to limitations related to dataset size, features, and classes. The integration of "probabilistic outputs, interactive visualizations, and model selection" enables the practical usability of the framework by incorporating a "probabilistic output, interactive visualization, and model selection" component, which is normally not possible with offline evaluation techniques. With the proposed framework, the gap between experimental machine learning models and water quality decision support systems is closed by considering "predictive performance, interpretability, and interactivity."

D. Comparative ROC–AUC Analysis of Machine Learning Models

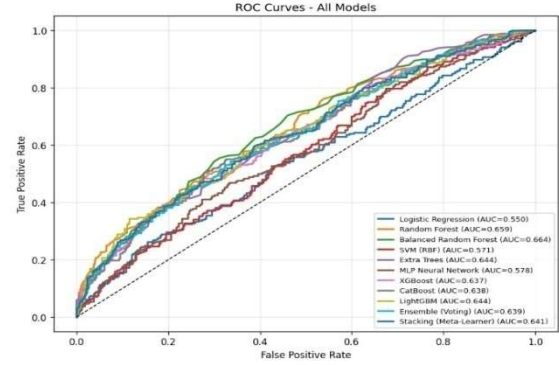


Fig. 5. ROC Curve Comparison of Individual and Ensemble Machine Learning Models for Water Potability Prediction

The ROC–AUC Comparative Analysis shows revised data at present time. The ROC curve comparison of individual and ensemble machine learning models is shown in Fig. 5. The model performance which organizations achieve needs to be evaluated based on how their curves approach the top-left corner of the graph. The results demonstrate that ensemble approaches which include Extra Trees and Balanced Random Forest and LightGBM and stacking-based models achieve higher AUC results when compared to linear classifiers and kernel-based classifiers. The research proves that ensemble learning provides better solutions for managing class imbalance and feature distribution problems which occur in water potability datasets.

VIII. DISCUSSION

The experimental results confirm that better performances of ensemble models over linear or kernel models in machine learning, particularly for prediction of water potability, can be explained by the extendibility of ensemble models in handling nonlinear relationships between physicochemical properties. The better performance of the Tree ensemble model, as well as the better performance of the Extra Trees ensemble model over the other models is observed in better generalization as well as more stable performance trends in calculating the prediction probability. The difference in the prediction probability values also implicitly reflects the inherent overlap between the potable and impotable data classes. The insights gained with the use of visual analytics also reflects the problems of data with missing values, class imbalance, as well as overlap in class distribution in all analyzed models. Overall, all these restrictions combine to result in moderate performances of all models for prediction of water potability, bridging the gap between experimental machine learning results and real-world machine learning.

IX. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

The research developed a complete machine learning system which uses physicochemical water quality data to determine whether water is safe for drinking. The

researchers assessed multiple classification models through a single method which handled data preprocessing and managed class imbalance but achieved the best results with the Extra Trees classifier. The proposed framework functions as a decision support system for drinking water quality assessment because it combines real-time predictions with probabilistic results and interactive visualizations. The upcoming research will achieve better prediction results through the use of extensive water quality databases which will include current sensor measurements from diverse sources. The system will achieve better model transparency and support its implementation across large-scale Internet of Things water monitoring systems through the combination of explainable artificial intelligence methods and geographic visualization components.

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